

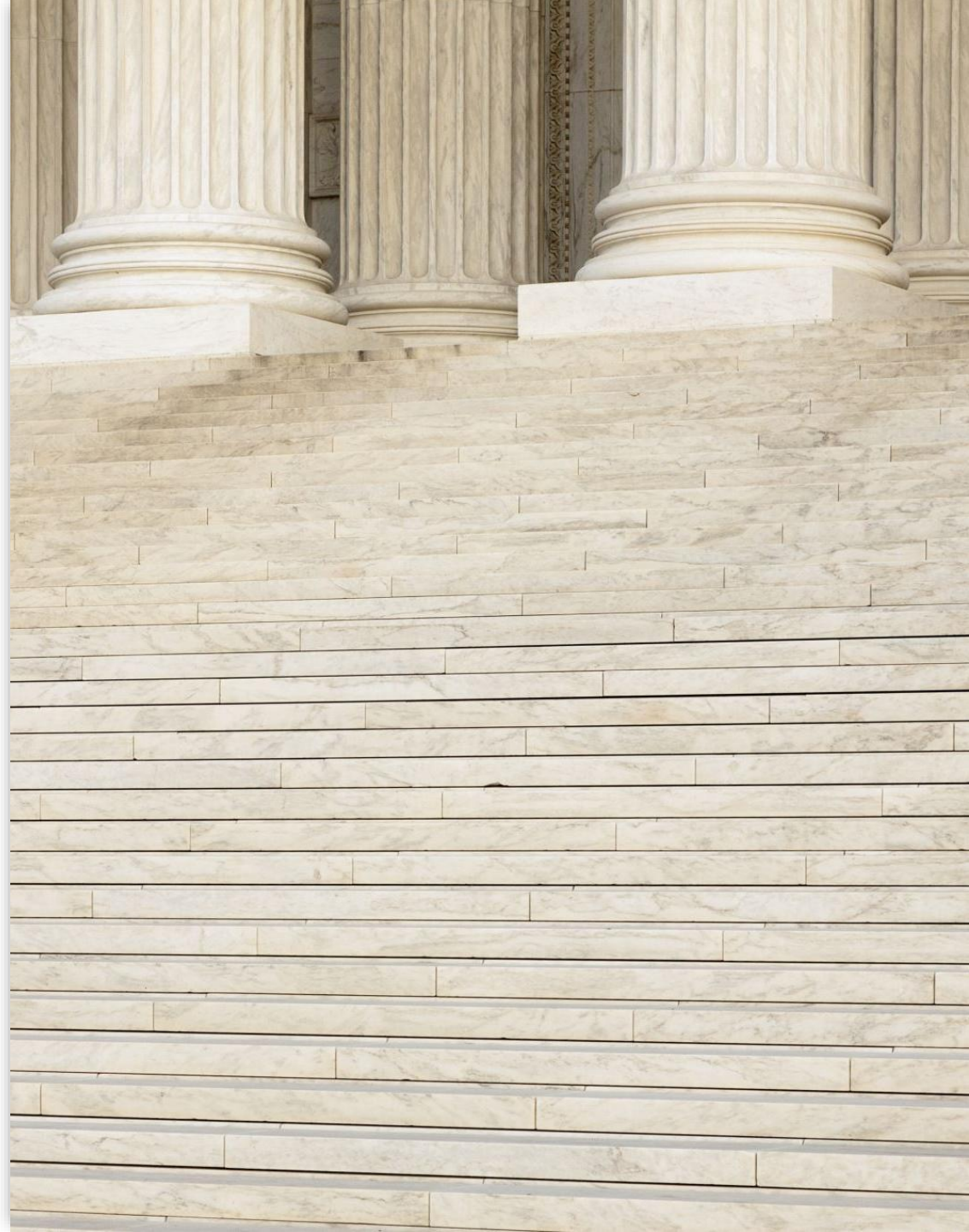
Inha University in Tashkent

Theme 1: The Collapse of the Soviet Union and the Proclamation of the Independence of Uzbekistan

Tashkent – 2024

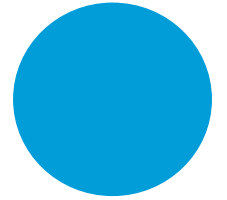
Outline:

- The Concept of History
- Periodization of the Subject
- Collapse of the Soviet Union
- Proclamation of Independence



What is History?

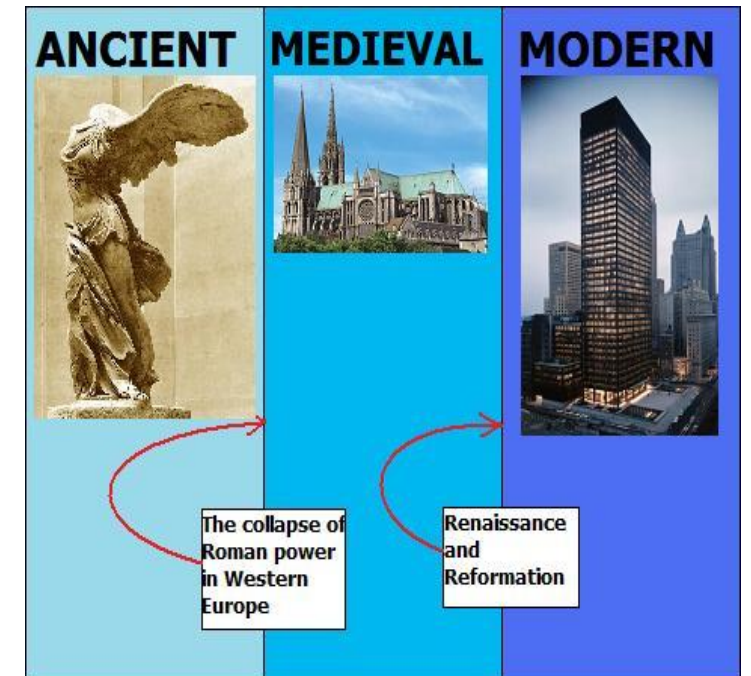
- The term is derived from Greek that means 'knowledge that acquired by investigation'
- Definition of the concept:
 - the events that occurred in the past
 - history is not a science, but a list of events of the past
 - only the activities of our ancestors
- According to Sharafiddin Ali Yazdi, 'it studies the reasons for the situation that has arisen in the country, explains by what measures the state has lived a pleasant life and the circumstances of which she has become on the path of destruction, and what needs to be done and what should not be done for the sake of the state's progress. These questions are answered by the science of history.'



Periodization of the History of Uzbekistan

The following periodization of history has been systematized and adopted by majority scholars:

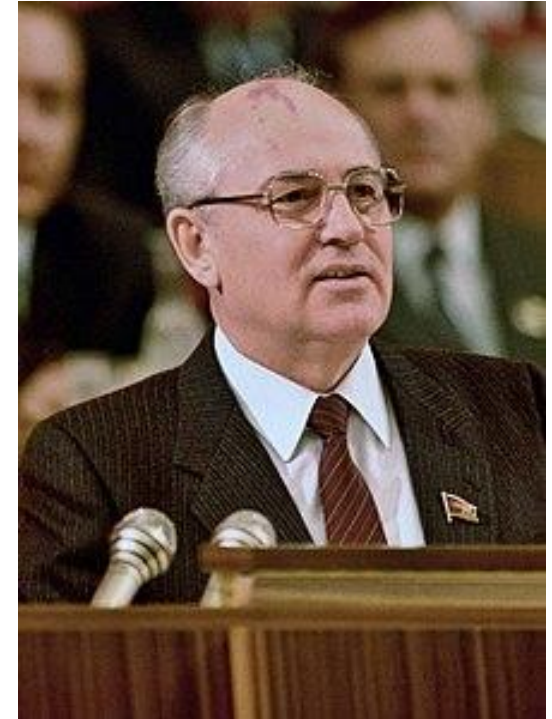
- 1) Primitive society (3-2 million – 8-7 century BC)
- 2) The period of Antiquity (8-7 century BC – 5 century AD)
- 3) Middle Ages (5 century – 19 century)
- 4) The Colonial period (19 century - 1917)
- 5) The Soviet period (1917-1991)
- 6) The period of National Independence (1991-present)



The Soviet Union



- The Soviet Union (Union of Soviet Socialist Republics) was a socialist state in Eurasia
- It existed from 1922 to 1991
- the Soviet Union consisted of 15 socialist republics
- Characteristic features of the state:
 - one-party state, governed by the Communist Party
 - government and economy were highly centralized
- Mikhail Gorbachev was elected as a General Secretary of the Communist Party in 1985.
- He introduced new policy which called *perestroika* (restructuring) referring to political and economic system.
- The policy was the cause of the collapse of the Soviet Union and the end of the Cold War



Factors of Independence

There are three main steps and factors for achieving independence of Uzbekistan

- 1) Law 'On the State Language' was adopted on October 21, 1989
- 2) Presidential form of government - March 24, 1990
- 3) Declaration of Independence - June 20, 1990.
 - Decisions adopted by the Supreme Soviet of the USSR will be valid in the territory of Uzbekistan only after approval by the Supreme Soviet of the Uzbek SSR in accordance with the Constitution of the Uzbek SSR
 - Authority of the Uzbek SSR includes all matters related to domestic and foreign policies of the Uzbek SSR

The economic and socio- political State

- *In economy*
 - ✓ Uzbekistan ranked 12th in terms of GDP per capita, while the GNP per capita income is two times lower than the Soviet Union's average.
 - ✓ In terms of labor productivity in the industry, Uzbekistan was about 40 percent behind the country and twice as much in terms of agricultural productivity.
- *In socio-politics*
 - ✓ The mass riots organized by the violent forces in the Ferghana region in May 1989, grew dramatically by the end of June
 - ✓ Bloodshed was continued in Boka and Parkent districts of Tashkent region on February 19-20, 1990



Proclamation of Independence

- Uzbek SSR participated in the referendum on the issue of foundation of the Union of Sovereign States in March 1991 that aimed to avert the collapse of the Soviet Union.
- The results were never implemented after August Coup (the State Committee on the State of Emergency)
- On August 25, 1991, the special decree of the President of Uzbekistan was published. Under the decree, the Ministry of Internal Affairs and the State Security Committee were taken under the jurisdiction of the Uzbek SSR.

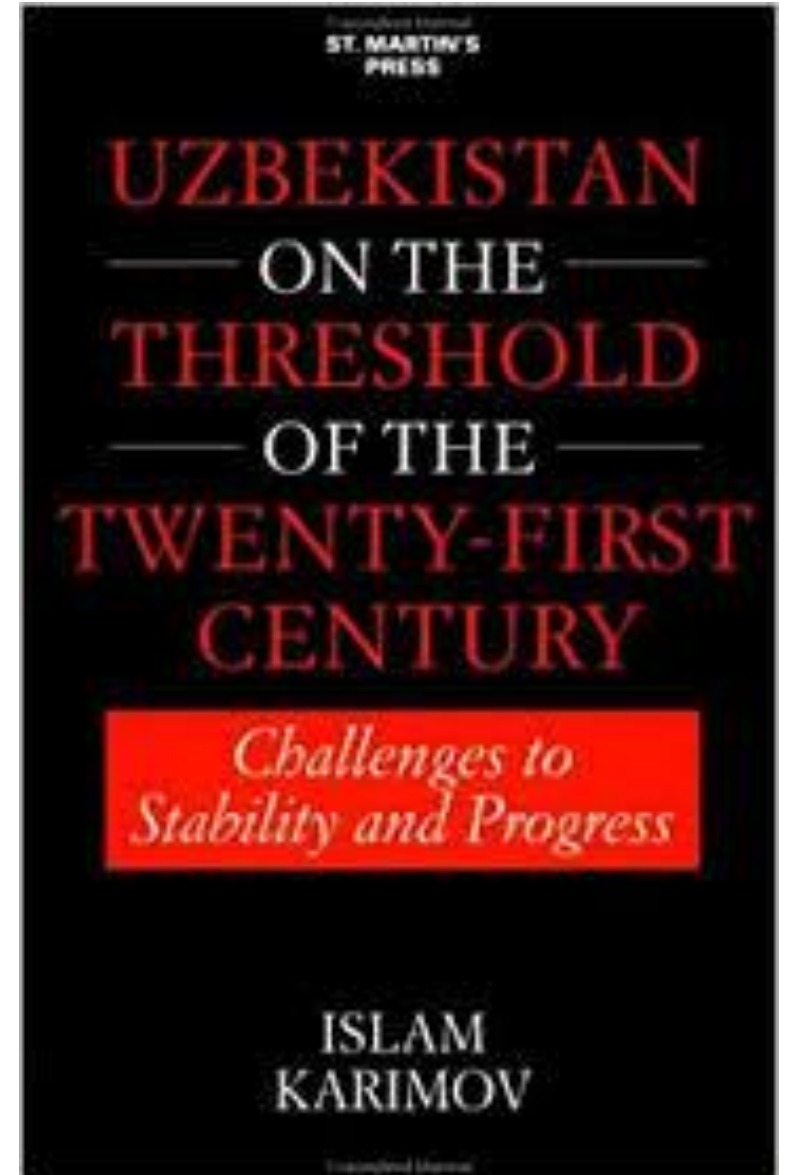
Internal troops of the Ministry of Internal Affairs of the USSR, located on the territory of the republic, were directly subordinated to the President of Uzbekistan.
- On August 31, 1991, the extraordinary sixth session of the Supreme Council of the Republic of Uzbekistan took place. The Supreme Council adopted the law "On the Principles of State Independence of the Republic of Uzbekistan" and Uzbekistan became an Independent State.



The factors of instability

- The first President of Uzbekistan, Islam Karimov in his book, "Uzbekistan on the Threshold of the Twenty-First Century: Challenges to Stability and Progress" specifically indicate the factors that threaten the security in the Central Asian region, particularly in Uzbekistan. These factors are:

1. Regional conflicts
2. Religious extremism and fundamentalism
3. Great state chauvinism and aggressive nationalism
4. Ethnic and inter-ethnic conflicts
5. Corruption and crime
6. Localism and tribalism
7. Environmental issues



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